

DIRECTIONS *for questions 1 to 4:* The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

... [Back in the 70s] West Germany and France, Europe's two central powers, looked out for each other. They sorted out their differences in private, and then used their combined weight to set the agenda for the European Union (EU) club. Today things work differently. On many policy subjects, France and Germany are now openly divided. ... The former wanted to cut short the endless Brexit negotiations; the latter was willing to prolong them... France wants to integrate the euro zone further, to prepare it for the next crisis; Germany frets about moral hazard.

The more the EU gains members, shrinks in relative global weight, and faces ever-tougher circumstances, the more it struggles to present a common front...In these circumstances, and with the Franco-German engine stalling, three smaller countries are becoming more influential: Spain, the Netherlands and Austria.

Spain under Pedro Sánchez, the centre-left prime minister, is a natural ally to Emmanuel Macron's France. He hopes to make Spain a new third partner in the Franco-German alliance. Madrid has particularly good relations with other southern European countries like Italy and Greece, but also makes a good interlocutor for Mr Scholz's Germany... The Netherlands under Mark Rutte, meanwhile, has close links with both Mr Scholz and with Mr Macron. The Netherlands has made itself influential by marshalling a "Hanseatic" alliance against the fiscal integration that the likes of Mr Macron and Mr Sánchez want. In this, it has allies across Scandinavian and Baltic Europe. Lastly, there is Austria. ... This small Alpine republic has become a potent voice in European debates on immigration and a broker of compromises between the EU's liberal western states and its conservative-dominated eastern ones.

The three countries have similarities. All have close links with France and Germany; all can marshal coalitions of like-minded states in their parts of Europe: all have modernising leaders with experiences of arduous coalition-building at home. One could call them "the Habsburgs", as all were at one time controlled by that dynasty which, like its successors in Madrid, The Hague and Vienna, played off other powers at Europe's core against each another.

One illustration of the new mechanics came with the recent debate in the EU about cutting carbon emissions to zero by 2050. Germany was at first unwilling, but the Netherlands and Spain formed an alliance with France. That pushed Germany towards the goal. Austria then swung in, followed by some central European states like Slovenia. Together, the Habsburg states spread a measure initially backed by just eight EU states to at least 18 of them.

Spain, the Netherlands, and Austria are too disparate to act as a bloc. Instead, individually or in various combinations, they can help the French and the Germans build new coalitions...A political scientist, Gilles Finchelstein argues that, once, European politics was made up of "solid" power blocs. Then after the fall of the Berlin Wall they became "liquid" with a less predictable European political landscape. Today, he concludes, is the "gaseous era" in which political coalitions come together for brief periods like clouds of smoke, then are blown apart again. Such gaseous constellations will define Europe's politics in the coming years.

Q1. The main idea of the passage is to demonstrate how

- ☐ a) European politics is driven by temporary and myopic interests.
- ☐ b) the two power blocs of Europe do not hold clout anymore.
- ☒ c) **the future of European politics looks as temporary as wisps of smoke.** ✗ **Your answer is incorrect**
- ☐ d) European politics is now dominated by temporary coalitions rather than permanent blocs.

Q2. All of the following have been listed out as similarities between Spain, the Netherlands and Austria EXCEPT:

- ☐ a) all of them share an amicable relationship with the two central powers of Europe.
- ☐ b) all of them are led by leaders who are experienced at consensus-building.
- ☐ c) **all of them are desperate to present a united front.**
- ☐ d) all of them have a certain degree of geopolitical clout.

Q3. Which of the following is not part of the author's portrayal of the changing dynamics of European politics?

- ☐ a) The more the EU gains in members, the more it is shrinking in global weight.
- ☐ b) Austria has become a broker of compromises between the EU's liberal western states and its conservative-dominated eastern ones.
- ☒ c) **The Habsburg states are too disparate to act as a bloc.** ✖ **Your answer is incorrect**
- ☐ d) France wanted to cut short the endless Brexit negotiations, whereas Germany was willing to prolong them.

Q4. The author mentions the Hanseatic alliance to show that the Netherlands

- ☐ a) is as influential as Spain and Austria if not more.
- ☐ b) can marshal a coalition of like-minded states in some parts of Europe.
- ☐ c) has closer links to Germany than to France and Spain.
- ☒ d) has allies across Scandinavian and Baltic Europe. **✗ Your answer is incorrect**

DIRECTIONS *for questions 5 to 8:* The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

A century ago, a man named Frederick Winslow Taylor changed the way workers work. In his book *The Principles of Scientific Management*, Taylor made the case that companies needed to be pragmatic and methodical in their efforts to boost productivity. By observing employees' performance and whittling down the time and effort involved in doing each task, he argued, management could ensure that their workers ... did all sorts of "crude and elementary" work as efficiently as possible. "Soldiering" – a common term in the day for the manual laborer's loafing – would no longer be possible under the rigors of the new system, Taylor wrote.

The principles of data-driven planning first laid out by Taylor ... have transformed the modern workplace ... And as the metrics have become more precise in their detail, their focus has shifted beyond the tasks themselves and onto the workers doing those tasks, evaluating a broad range of their qualities and tying corporate carrots and sticks ... to those ratings.

In her illuminating new book, *Weapons of Math Destruction*, the data scientist Cathy O'Neil describes how companies, schools, and governments evaluate consumers, workers, and students based on ever more abundant data about their lives. She makes a convincing case that this reliance on algorithms has gone too far: Algorithms often fail to capture unquantifiable concepts such as workers' motivation and care, and discriminate against the poor and others who can't so easily game the metrics.

Basing decisions on impartial algorithms rather than subjective human appraisals would appear to prevent the incursion of favoritism, nepotism, and other biases. But as O'Neil thoughtfully observes, statistical models that measure performance have biases that arise from those of their creators. As a result, algorithms are often unfair and sometimes harmful. "Models are opinions embedded in mathematics," she writes.

One example O'Neil raises is the "value-added" model of teacher evaluations, used controversially in New York City schools and elsewhere, which decide whether teachers get to keep their jobs based in large part on what she calls a straightforward but poor and easily fudged proxy for their overall ability: the test scores of their students. According to data from New York City, she notes ... that "the evaluation data is practically random." Meanwhile, harder-to-quantify qualities such as how well teachers engage their students or manage the classrooms go largely ignored....

How might these flaws be addressed? O'Neil's argument boils down to a belief that some of these algorithms aren't good or equitable enough – yet. Ultimately, she writes, they need to be refined with sounder statistical methods or tweaked to ensure fairness and protect people from disadvantaged backgrounds.

Q5. The author provides the example of "value-added" model of teacher evaluations in the penultimate paragraph primarily to

- ☐ a) emphasize that the statistical models for evaluation are usually controversial.
- ☐ b) highlight the inadequacies of statistical models which are based on poor metrics.
- ☐ c) **illustrate the near impossibility of designing an algorithm for monitoring harder-to-quantify qualities.**
- ☐ d) **indicate that statistical models cannot be used for evaluating employees' performance.**

Q6. According to Cathy O'Neil, which of the following is a shortcoming of statistical models that measure performance?

- ☐ a) The creators of statistical models rig these models so that they are beneficial to the people they like.
- ☐ b) Most of the statistical models ignore the data related to the metrics that are critical for evaluating performance.
- ☐ c) **It is difficult to design statistical models which can link the multitude of metrics which go into performance evaluation.**
- ☐ d) **The biases of the creators of the statistical models end up in the algorithms which makes the algorithms unfair.**

Q7. Which of the following approaches would Frederick Winslow Taylor have most likely discussed in his book *The Principles of Scientific Management*?

- ☐ a) Using data-dependent statistical models for evaluating the performance of the workers.
- ☐ b) Using a data-driven approach for determining the optimum time required to complete tasks which require less skill.
- ☐ c) **Using a data-driven approach for incentivizing workers to improve their efficiency.**
- ☐ d) **Using a data-dependent approach for discriminating between the slackers and exceptional performers.**

Q8. O'Neil would approve of which of the following hypothetical methods to address flaws in statistical models?

- ☐ a) Incorporating metrics such as a worker's interests and hobbies to determine which role in the organization would suit her best.
- ☐ b) Designing performance metrics which consider a worker's familial background and upbringing.
- ☐ c) **Taking a closer look at the factors behind consistent exceptional performance of a worker and using these factors as performance metrics for other workers.**
- ☐ d) **Educating workers on what metrics the statistical model uses to determine performance levels.**

DIRECTIONS *for questions 9 to 12:* The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The first power station to produce electricity by using heat from the splitting of uranium atoms began operating in the 1950s. Some isotopes of atoms are 'unstable' since their nucleus changes over time – from milliseconds to millennia – as they emit charged particles or waves, making them 'radioactive'. It is the radioactive nature of these unstable atoms (radioisotopes), which gives them so many applications in nuclear energy, agriculture, medicine and industry.

In 1911, George de Hevesy was a young Hungarian student working in Manchester with naturally radioactive materials. Not having much money, he took his meals with his landlady. He suspected that some of the meals might be made from leftovers from the preceding days. To confirm his suspicions de Hevesy put a small amount of radioactive material into the remains of a meal. Few days later when the same dish was served again, he used a gold leaf electroscope and observed that the food was radioactive. History has forgotten the landlady, but George de Hevesy won the Nobel prize in 1943. His was the first use of radioactive tracers.

Radioisotopes play an important part in technologies that provide us with basic needs like food, water and good health. Radioisotopes and radiation used in agriculture are helping to reduce the number of people worldwide who die of malnutrition and hunger. Fertilisers are expensive and if not properly used can damage the environment. It is important that as much of the fertiliser as possible finds its way into plants and that a minimum is lost to the environment. Fertilisers 'labelled' with a particular isotope, such as nitrogen-15 and phosphorus-32 provide a means of finding out how much is taken up by the plant and how much is lost.

Crop losses caused by insects may amount to more than 10% of the total harvest worldwide. Stock losses due to tsetse in Africa and screwworm in Mexico have also been sizeable. Chemical insecticides have not always been effective in reducing the losses. Some insects have become resistant to the chemicals used, and some insecticides leave poisonous residues on the crops. Insecticides can contaminate soil, water, turf, and other vegetation and can also pose risks to non-target organisms. One solution has been the use of sterile insects.

The Sterile Insect Technique (SIT) involves rearing large numbers of insects and then irradiating their eggs with gamma radiation before hatching, to sterilise them. Sterile males are released in large numbers in infested areas. When they mate with females, no offspring are produced. With repeated releases of sterilised males, insect pest population in the project area is drastically reduced.

Ionising radiation to induce mutations in plant breeding has been used for several decades to produce new genetic lines of sorghum, garlic, wheat, bananas, beans and peppers, cereals and oil seed crops which are more resistant to pests and more adaptable to harsh climatic conditions. Some 25-30% of the food harvested in many countries is lost as a result of spoilage by microbes and pests. Today, in over 40 countries, health and safety authorities have approved irradiation of more than 60 kinds of food, ranging from spices, grains and grain products to fruit, vegetables and meat. On their trips into space, astronauts eat foods preserved by irradiation.

Q9. The passage cites the episode of George de Hevesy and the landlady to

- ☐ a) explore the usefulness of radioactive isotopes in the area of food irradiation.
- ☐ b) humorously introduce the subject of uncommon applications of isotopes.
- ☐ c) **point out the beginnings of the practical application of isotopes.**
- ☐ d) **show that isotopes can be used for unimaginative or silly experiments too.**

Q10. Which of the following has been suggested in the passage as a disadvantage of chemical insecticides?

- ☐ a) They can indirectly produce new mutations in the genetic lines of root and tuber crops, cereals and oil seed crops.
- ☐ b) Chemical insecticides can be toxic to a host of other non-target organisms.
- ☐ c) **They catalyse the crop losses caused by insects.**
- ☐ d) **They can act only on a localized area and cannot affect different types of insects with the same efficiency.**

Q11. Which of the following factors plays a pertinent role in determining the success rate of the Sterile Insect Technique (SIT) program as discussed in the passage?

- ☐ a) Higher proportion of laboratory-bred male insects in comparison to normal male insects in infested areas
- ☐ b) The proportion of laboratory-bred male insects in infested areas which do not become resistant to the chemical pesticides used
- ☐ c) **A higher ratio of laboratory-bred female insects to wild type male insects in infested areas**
- ☐ d) **Homogeneous cohorts of laboratory-bred insects which are similar to wild type male insects and can replace the latter when the latter are not available**

Q12. The attitude or response of the author of the passage towards the idea of radioisotope technology can be best described as one of

- ☐ a) guarded appreciation
- ☐ b) implied scepticism
- ☐ c) **positive enthusiasm**
- ☐ d) **pointed criticism**

DIRECTIONS *for questions 13 to 16:* The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

You're almost unfathomably lucky to exist, in almost every conceivable way. You and me are nothing but impurities in an otherwise beautifully simple universe.

We're lucky life began on Earth at all and that something as complex as humans evolved. It was improbable that your parents met each other and conceived you at just the right instant, and their parents and so on back to time immemorial. This is science's way of reminding you to be grateful for what you have.

But your existence wasn't just predicated on luck of your ancestors, but on an almost absurdly finely tuned universe. Had the universe opted to turn up the strength of the electromagnetic force by even a small factor, poof! Suddenly stars wouldn't be able to produce any heavy elements, much less the giant wet rock we're standing on. Worse, if the universe were only minutely denser than the one we inhabit, it would have collapsed before it began.

Worse still, the laws of physics themselves seem to be working against us. Ours isn't just a randomly hostile universe, it's very hostile to our existence.

My physicist colleagues and I like to pretend that the laws of physics are orderly and elegant. Indeed, I just published an entire book, *The Universe in the Rearview Mirror*, about the beautiful symmetries of the universe. Programs like *Nova* or *Slate's* own *Bad Astronomy* tend to focus on the knowable structure of how everything fits together. However, if the entire universe were made symmetric, then all of the good features (e.g., you) are decidedly asymmetric lumps that ruin the otherwise perfect beauty of the cosmos.

But it would be a mistake to be comforted by the symmetries of the universe. ... The symmetry of the universe would bake us in no time at all, but an *asymmetry* rescues us. Kepler recognized that for the sky to be dark at all, the universe must be "enclosed and circumscribed by a wall or a vault."

That vault is the beginning of time.

The beginning of time introduces yet another obstacle to our existence. Protons and neutrons started to coalesce a millionth of a second after the first instant of time. Matter tended to pop into and out of existence, and with it, a mysterious-sounding substance known as antimatter. Antimatter is the mirror image of ordinary matter (hence the symmetry). A positron, the antimatter version of an electron, has the same mass as the ordinary version and it spins at the same rate. However, the positron has a positive charge and the electron has a negative one.

Matter and antimatter *should* have completely annihilated one another in the first nanoseconds after the Big Bang. You should not even exist. But you do, and there's lots more matter where you came from.

We live in a universe that seems to be made of matter. If the perfect symmetry between matter and antimatter remained perfect, you wouldn't be here to think about it.

Sometime very, very early on in the universe, there was a small break, and about a billion and one particles of matter were produced for every billion antiparticles. As for how that happened, we honestly can't say, because nobody's been able to reproduce it in a lab.

Q13. What does the author mean when he says “We’re lucky life began” in Para 1?

- ☐ a) It was very difficult to find a life partner for our parents.
- ☐ b) We are born on earth because of complex biological mechanisms.
- ☐ c) **It was very unlikely for complex biological systems to form.**
- ☐ d) **Although we are impure, we exist in a beautiful universe.**

Q14. Why does the author mention “*The Universe in the Rearview Mirror*” and “*Nova or Slate’s own Bad Astronomy*” ?

- ☐ a) To describe that the universe is very orderly and symmetrical.
- ☐ b) To draw a contrast between how the universe actually exists and how it is interpreted in the book.
- ☐ c) **To advertise the book and to highlight the importance of programs employed by astronomers.**
- ☐ d) **To admire the beauty of the universe.**

Q15. Which of the following cannot be clearly inferred from the passage?

- ☐ a) The universe is so precisely defined that even the slightest change in any of the factors would not have led to our existence.
- ☐ b) There are numerous disastrous activities taking place in the universe.
- ☐ c) **Difference in density and electromagnetic force would have altered the universe by a great degree.**
- ☐ d) **The “giant wet rock” refers to the earth.**

Q16. How is the discrepancy that we exist and are not destroyed explained in the passage?

- ☐ a) The properties of antimatter ensure that we are not destroyed and the fact that scientists have been unsuccessful in making antimatter versions of ourselves help in explaining our existence.
- ☐ b) We exist because the difference between matter and antimatter is very small and we are not destroyed because our antimatter does not exist.
- ☐ c) **The asymmetry between matter and antimatter in terms of number at the beginning of the universe might help explain the said discrepancy.**
- ☐ d) **We cannot say whether we are matter or antimatter here on earth and hence we exist. We are not destroyed because we haven't shaken hands with our antimatter twin.**

Q17. DIRECTIONS *for question 17:* The passage given below is followed by four summaries. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the text.

The fallacious idea that some characteristics of an organism are explained by the organism's intrinsic nature, whilst others reflect the influence of the environment is an ancient one. The distinction between innate and acquired traits in an organism might be understood within the area of psychology only as other fields such as molecular developmental biology and genetics have not been able to pinpoint the same. Recent philosophical analyses of the innate/acquired distinction can be classified into four types. The first identifies innate traits with those characteristic of an entire species and identifies acquired traits with those that vary between populations and individuals. The second identifies innate traits with those that can be explained by natural selection. The third, and most influential, identifies innate traits with those produced by particular patterns of interaction between genes and environment. The fourth is different and suggests that labelling a trait 'innate' is a way to indicate that it lies outside the domain of psychology. Philosophical scepticism about innateness draws on a longstanding tradition of scepticism in developmental psychobiology. This research tradition interprets many of its own results as demonstrating the inadequacy of the innate/acquired distinction. Once again, this suggests that the distinction may be best understood via its actual use in psychological research.

- ☐ a) The distinction between innate and acquired traits is largely a psychological one since it has not been supported by genetics or molecular developmental biology. Any relationship between genetic causation and the innate/acquired distinction will be far more complex than saying that innate traits are 'caused by genes' whilst acquired traits are 'caused by the environment'.
- ☐ b) The age-old debate between innate and acquired traits has not yet been resolved due to the reliance on genetics and molecular biology instead of psychological research. The idea that genetics and molecular developmental biology measure the degree to which a characteristic is innate is a vulgar fallacy. While three types of philosophical analyses explain the innate/acquired distinction, the fourth type draws our attention towards philosophical scepticism about innateness. Psychological research surfaces as the best area to study innateness.
- ☐ c) **Psychology still remains the only area within which the distinction between innate and acquired traits might be understood as other areas have failed to clarify the distinction. While three types of philosophical analyses explain the innate/ acquired distinction, the fourth type is unique as it highlights the scepticism in proving the adequacy of the innate/acquired distinction.**
- ☐ d) **The distinction between innate and acquired traits holds no water since studies have shown that no single property of a trait corresponds to its being innate. While genetics itself is well understood, its relationship to the innate/acquired distinction remains highly controversial.**

Q18. DIRECTIONS *for question 18:* There is a sentence that is missing in the paragraph below. Look at the paragraph and decide in which blank (option 1, 2, 3, or 4) the following sentence would best fit.
Sentence: **But there is an exception.**

Paragraph: Ammonia is as repulsive to most marine animals as it is to land-lubbing ones – and for good reason. It is extremely toxic. ____ (1) ____ Far from being repelled by ammonia, sharks are actually attracted to it. ____ (2) ____ The longtime assumption has been that this is because it is a waste product, voided into the water by fish and other creatures, that signals the presence of potential prey. ____ (3) ____ But Chris Wood and Marina Giacomini of the University of British Columbia, in Vancouver, think that there may be more to it than this. ____ (4) ____ They suspect that for sharks, ammonia is itself a useful resource.

- ☐ a) Option 1
- ☐ b) Option 2
- ☐ c) **Option 3**
- ☐ d) **Option 4**

Q19. DIRECTIONS *for question 19:* The sentences given in the question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a number. Decide on the proper order for the four sentences and key in the sequence of four numbers as your answer, in the input box given below the question.

1. Let's try to imagine 'Joker' without this reference to the Batman myth, just as the story of a victimized kid who adopts the mask of a clown to survive his predicament.

2. It simply wouldn't work, as it would have been just another realist drama.

3. It provides the dark genesis of the Batman story, a genesis that has to remain invisible for the Batman myth to function.

4. The reason for 'Joker's popularity resides in its meta-fictional dimension.

Q20. DIRECTIONS *for question 20:* The passage given below is followed by four summaries. Choose the option that best captures the author's position.

I don't believe that fiction really represents contemporary reality and its ideas all that well – there are other art forms that do it better. But it's an excellent place for exploring complex philosophical questions in an embodied way: to think about epistemological and ontological questions, to think about the way the mind functions. I think of the story as a kind of laboratory for alternative experience: a means of living through possible situations and lives in a way that is intensive and affective for the reader but also operates at a remove. I think fiction can be experiential, and in that sense it's something that can bring about a profound change in the person reading it.

- ☐ a) Fiction isn't as effective as other art forms to show one the reality, but it is highly effective in showing readers an alternative reality.
- ☐ b) While fiction trails some other art forms in terms of depicting contemporary ideas, it is a great medium for experiential and explorative purposes.
- ☐ c) **Fiction helps one experience sensations they wouldn't otherwise explore, and that alone makes it worth it for the reader.**
- ☐ d) **The story is a great way of tackling philosophical questions by placing oneself in another's shoes.**

Q21. DIRECTIONS *for question 21:* The sentences given in the question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a number. Decide on the proper order for the four sentences and key in the sequence of four numbers as your answer, in the input box given below the question.

1. He is a specialist on slow clay surfaces, but ahead of his arrival in New York he had won fewer than half of his matches on hard courts.
2. Mr Schwartzman, nicknamed “El Peque” (“the small one”), had only once before reached the third round of a major.
3. Now that the men’s field is down to the final eight, one name is particularly surprising: Diego Schwartzman, a 25-year-old Argentine who is just five feet and seven inches tall.
4. With former champions Novak Djokovic, Andy Murray, and Stan Wawrinka all missing from this year’s US Open, a throng of less-familiar names are headed to Flushing with a chance to make a name for themselves.

Q22. DIRECTIONS *for question 22:* There is a sentence that is missing in the paragraph below. Look at the paragraph and decide in which blank (option 1, 2, 3, or 4) the following sentence would best fit.
Only by making certain approximations can solutions be found.

The idea of gravitational waves emerged from the general theory of relativity, Albert Einstein's fundamental exposition of gravity, unveiled almost exactly 100 years ago. Mass, Einstein realized, deforms the space and time around itself. _____(1)_____ Gravity is the effect of this, the behaviour of objects dutifully moving along the curves of mass-warped space-time. It is a simple idea, but the equations that give it mathematical heft are damnably hard to solve. _____(2)_____ And one such approximation led Einstein to an odd prediction: any accelerating mass should make ripples in spacetime. Einstein was not happy with this idea. He would, himself, oscillate like a wave on the topic – rescinding and remaking his case, arguing for such waves and then, after redoing the sums, against them. _____(3)_____ But, while he and others stretched and squeezed the maths, experimentalists set about trying to catch the putative waves in the act of stretching and squeezing matter. _____(4)_____ But the waves themselves proved elusive until the construction of the Advanced Laser Interferometer Gravitational-wave Observatory (LIGO).

- ☐ a) Option 1
- ☐ b) Option 2
- ☐ c) **Option 3**
- ☐ d) **Option 4**

Q23. DIRECTIONS *for question 23:* The sentences given in the question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a number. Decide on the proper order for the four sentences and key in the sequence of four numbers as your answer, in the input box given below the question.

- 1. As though inside you is this enormous room full of what seems like everything in the whole universe at one time or another and yet the only parts that get out have to somehow squeeze out through one of those tiny keyholes you see under the knob in older doors.
- 2. As if we are all trying to see each other through these tiny keyholes.
- 3. You already know the difference between the size and speed of everything that flashes through you and the tiny inadequate bit of it all you can ever let anyone know.
- 4. The truth is you already know what it's like.

Q24. DIRECTIONS *for question 24:* The passage given below is followed by four summaries. Choose the option that best captures the author's position.

Leaders should be mindful that the expression of diverse perspectives in teams needs to be managed. Cognitive diversity is essential for generating novel, innovative solutions to complex problems, especially during the planning and ideation phases of a project. However, the expression of diverse perspectives can quickly become a liability when the team needs to focus on execution and meet looming deadlines. It is during these times that team members have to unify around a common interpretation of the problem and come to agreement about what needs to get done to solve it. Leaders must be adept at switching back and forth, learning when and how to promote the expression of divergent opinions and meanings and when to create a context for convergence.

- ☐ a) Leaders should know how to walk the tightrope between encouraging diversity during planning and encouraging unity of perspectives during implementation.
- ☐ b) A good leader is someone who knows when to encourage diversity and when to discourage it.
- ☐ c) **A leader must understand that diversity offers an advantage while solving complex problems but is disadvantageous when dealing with looming deadlines.**
- ☐ d) **Leadership is about balancing diverse opinions while focusing on a unified goal.**